ZOOM FOR PROFESSIONALS

Instructor Script & Facilitator Guide

Primary Instructor Edition

Duration	3 hours (including two 10-minute breaks)
Format	Instructor-led with live demonstrations and hands-on practice
Audience	Adult professionals with moderate computer experience
Room Setup	Participants logged into Zoom on their own devices
Support	Secondary instructor monitors chat throughout the session

How to Use This Guide

This script is written for the PRIMARY INSTRUCTOR. It follows the PowerPoint slide deck slide by slide and provides:

- Word-for-word suggested narration in regular text
- **ACTION:** Instructor actions and cues in
- **CHAT MONITOR:** Secondary instructor coordination notes in
- Timing guides at the top of each slide section
- Transition phrases to move smoothly between topics

TIP You do not need to read this script verbatim. Use it as a guide and speak naturally. The goal is confident, conversational delivery — not a recitation.

Pre-Session Preparation (15 min before start)

ACTION	Arrive 15 minutes early. Log into the practice Zoom room. Confirm your audio, video, and screen share are working. Have the slide deck open and ready to share.

CHAT MONITOR	Secondary instructor: Join the Zoom room early. Paste the welcome message in chat: "Welcome! We'll begin shortly. While you wait, make sure your audio and video are enabled." Monitor for any technical issues as participants join.

As Participants Join

As people start joining, greet them warmly on camera:

"Good [morning/afternoon], everyone — welcome! Go ahead and turn on your camera if you're comfortable doing so, and feel free to wave hello. We'll get started in just a couple of minutes."

Watch for participants having trouble joining. If someone reports an issue in chat, the secondary instructor will handle it so you can keep greeting new arrivals.

Slide 1	Title Slide — Zoom for Professionals	0:00 – 0:03

ACTION Start screen share. Display Slide 1. Begin when most participants are present and the clock hits the start time.

Opening — Say:

"Welcome, everyone — I'm glad you're here. My name is [your name], and today we're going to spend three hours learning Zoom together — not just the basics, but the features that will make you confident and professional on every call."

"Before I go any further, let me introduce my colleague [secondary instructor name], who will be monitoring our chat the entire time. If you have a question, a technical issue, or something isn't making sense, just type it in chat and they'll either answer it directly or bring it to my attention. No question is too small — that's what the chat is for."

"We have two short breaks built in, and plenty of time for hands-on practice near the end. Let's get started."

CHAT MONITOR Post in chat: "Questions welcome any time! Type them here, and I'll answer or flag for the instructor."

Slide 2	About This Training	0:03 – 0:08

Say:

"Here's a quick overview of what today looks like. On the left, you can see a description of our two-instructor format. I'll be leading all the instruction and demonstrations. [Name] in the chat is your support line — use them freely."

"On the right, you'll see the key details: we're going three hours, there are two breaks, and by the end of today, you'll be able to host and manage a Zoom meeting confidently on your own."

"You'll each receive a quick-reference card and keyboard shortcuts list at the end — so don't stress about memorizing everything. Your job today is to understand what's possible and get comfortable using the tools."

Pause and ask:

"Does anyone have questions before we look at the agenda? No? Great — let's go."

Slide 3	Training Agenda	0:08 – 0:12

Say:

"Here's our agenda for today. We have seven blocks — five teaching modules and two breaks."

"We start with the basics: getting Zoom installed and joining your first meeting. Then we move into meeting controls — your toolbar, muting, video, reactions, and chat. After our first break, we cover collaboration features like screen sharing and breakout rooms."

"Then we look at security and settings — this is one people often skip, but it matters a lot in a professional environment. After the second break, we close with a live practice session and open Q&A."

"I want this to feel relaxed and practical. If something is confusing, stop me. If the chat monitor is already answering your question, great — but raise your hand or type in chat anytime."

ACTION Advance to Module 1 section header slide.

MODULE 1: Getting Started with Zoom

Slide 4	Module 1 Section Header	0:12 – 0:13

Say:

"Module one: Getting Started. We're going to cover downloading and installing Zoom, understanding the interface, and joining your very first meeting. If you've already done some of this, great — stick with us because we'll fill in any gaps."

Slide 5	Module 1 Content — Download, Interface, Joining	0:13 – 0:42

Download & Install — Say:

"Let's start by making sure everyone has Zoom installed. The desktop app gives you the most features, so that's what we recommend. You download it at zoom.us — I'll have [chat monitor name] drop that link in chat right now."

CHAT MONITOR	Post: "Download Zoom here: https://zoom.us/download — choose 'Zoom Desktop Client'"

"Once it's installed, sign in with your work email or create a free account. Now — important distinction: the browser version of Zoom works in a pinch, but it doesn't have all the features. If you're using the browser today, that's fine, but I encourage you to install the desktop app."

ACTION	LIVE DEMO: Share your screen and walk through zoom.us. Show where to find the download link. Open the desktop app and point out the sign-in screen. You don't need to sign in and out — just narrate what participants would do.

The Zoom Interface — Say:

"Once you're signed in, you see this home screen. Let me walk you through the four big buttons at the top."

"'New Meeting' — that's how you start an instant meeting right now. 'Join' — you enter someone else's meeting ID to join their call. 'Schedule' — this is how you set up a meeting in advance and send calendar invites. And 'Share Screen' — lets you share directly without a meeting, useful for quick demos."

"The gear icon in the top right is your Settings. We'll come back to that in Module 5 on security. For now, just know it's there."

"And notice — my colleague [name] is in the chat right now. That's the Chat panel on the right side of your Zoom window. In a meeting, it works the same way — a side panel where everyone can communicate in writing."

Joining a Meeting — Say:

"Now, joining a meeting. Most of the time, you'll get an invitation link in your email or calendar. Click it, and Zoom opens automatically. Easy."

"If you're given a Meeting ID instead of a link, click 'Join' on the home screen, type in the ID, and you're in."

"Before you enter, Zoom will ask about your audio and video. You can preview how you look, test your microphone, and choose a virtual background if you want one. Take a few seconds to do this every time — it's professional."

"The last thing I'll mention here is the Waiting Room. Many professional meetings use it — you join, but you wait in a virtual lobby until the host admits you. Don't be surprised by it. Just wait — the host will let you in when they're ready."

TIP	Check in with the group here: "Does everyone feel good about the installation and joining process? Any questions in chat? Thumbs up if you're with me." Allow the chat monitor 15-20 seconds to collect responses before continuing.

MODULE 2: Meeting Controls & Tools

Slide 6	Module 2 Section Header	0:42 – 0:43

Say:

"Module two — meeting controls. This is where we really get into the details of what all those buttons at the bottom of your screen do. Once you know your toolbar, you'll feel at home in any Zoom call."

Slide 7	Module 2 Content — Toolbar, Exercise, Chat Monitor	0:43 – 1:00

Toolbar Controls — Say:

"Your main meeting toolbar sits at the bottom of the screen. Let's go through it left to right."

"Mute and Unmute — this is the most important button in Zoom. The rule is simple: if you're not talking, you're muted. Background noise is distracting for everyone. The keyboard shortcut to quickly unmute is Spacebar — hold it down to speak, release to mute again."

"Start and Stop Video — this controls your camera. You can also set a virtual background here. Virtual backgrounds are great when your surroundings aren't professional. I'd encourage everyone to set one up today."

"Reactions — this little button is underused and very useful. You can raise your hand without interrupting, give a thumbs up, or clap. In a large meeting, use Raise Hand to signal you want to speak."

"Participants — this opens a panel showing everyone in the meeting. As a host, this is where you see raised hands, manage who can speak, and mute individuals if needed."

"Chat — opens the chat panel. You can message everyone or send a private message to one person. You can also share files here. Note: the host can restrict chat if needed — we'll cover that in security."

"Record — Zoom can record to your computer or to the cloud. Cloud recordings are easier to share. Important rule: you must tell participants if you're recording. Zoom actually pops up a notification for them automatically, but it's still good practice to say it out loud."

ACTION	HANDS-ON EXERCISE: Ask participants to do the following four things and give them about 90 seconds: • Mute and unmute themselves • Turn their camera on and set a virtual background • Use the Raise Hand reaction • Send a message in the group chat

"Go ahead — take about 90 seconds and try all four of those things. I'll watch for raised hands."

CHAT MONITOR	Watch chat for people who need help. If someone can't find a feature, respond directly with step-by-step instructions. Flag any common confusion for the instructor.

"Great work, everyone. Lower your hands when you're done — or if you're still struggling with something, keep it raised and [name] will come find you in chat."

TIP	This is a good moment to acknowledge that the controls look slightly different on Mac vs. PC vs. mobile. If anyone mentions this in chat, validate it and reassure them the core features are the same.

BREAK 1

Slide —	10-Minute Break	1:00 – 1:10

Say:

"We've earned a break! We'll take ten minutes — be back at [time]. When we come back, we're moving into collaboration tools: screen sharing, breakout rooms, and polling."

CHAT MONITOR	Post break-end time in chat: "Break until [X: XX]. See you back here at [time]!" Collect any unanswered questions from chat and prepare them for the instructor.

ACTION	Pause screen share or show a 'Back in 10 Minutes' slide. Mute yourself. Return 2 minutes early to greet returning participants.

MODULE 4: Collaboration Features

Slide 8	Module 4 — Screen Share, Breakout Rooms, Polling	1:10 – 1:45

Intro — Say:

"Welcome back, everyone. We're moving into my favorite part: collaboration. Zoom isn't just for passive meetings — it's built for people to actually work together, and these tools make that possible."

Screen Sharing — Say:

"Screen sharing is the most-used collaboration tool in Zoom. Hit the green 'Share Screen' button in your toolbar, and you'll see a window that lets you choose what to share: your entire desktop, a specific application window, or a whiteboard."

"My advice: share a specific application window, not your whole screen. That way, participants only see what you intend — they don't accidentally see your email, other files, or anything you don't mean to share."

"As a participant, you can request control of the host's screen — that's useful for IT support calls or collaborative work. The host has to approve it."

ACTION	LIVE DEMO: Share a specific application window. Narrate what you're doing. Point out the green bar at the top of the screen that appears when sharing is active — and how to stop sharing.

Breakout Rooms — Say:

"Breakout rooms let the host split participants into smaller groups automatically. This is fantastic for team exercises, small group discussions, or anything that benefits from a smaller audience."

"As the host, you create breakout rooms under the 'Breakout Rooms' button in the toolbar. You can assign people automatically or manually. You can move between rooms to check in, and when you're ready, you close the rooms, and everyone returns automatically."

"As a participant, you'll get a pop-up inviting you into a breakout room. Just click 'Join.' When the host closes the rooms, you'll get a 30-second countdown and return automatically."

CHAT MONITOR	When breakout room exercises begin, post the task instructions in chat so participants have them while in their rooms.

Polling & Engagement — Say:

"Polls are a great way to check understanding, gather opinions, or just re-engage a group that's been passively listening. As a host, you create polls in advance in your Zoom account settings, then launch them during the meeting."

"You can also annotate on a shared screen — draw, highlight, or type directly on whatever is being shared. This is available to participants, too, though hosts can turn it off."

"One note: Q&A is a separate feature from Chat that's specific to Zoom Webinars — if your organization uses webinars for large all-hands meetings, Q&A is how attendees ask questions. We won't go deep on webinars today, but it's worth knowing the distinction."

MODULE 5: Security & Settings

Slide 9	Module 5 — Security Best Practices & Mistakes to Avoid	1:45 – 2:15

Intro — Say:

"Security. I know — not the most exciting word. But this section might be the most important one for you professionally. A security mistake in Zoom can disrupt a meeting, expose confidential information, or create a very awkward situation with clients. Let's make sure none of that happens to you."

Meeting Passwords — Say:

"Always require a password for sensitive meetings. When you schedule a meeting in Zoom, there's a checkbox to require a passcode — turn it on. Share the password through a secure channel, not in a public Slack channel or social media post."

Waiting Room — Say:

"Enable the Waiting Room by default. This means no one enters your meeting automatically — you admit each person individually. It only takes a few seconds, and it gives you full control over who's in the room. For any sensitive call — with clients, executives, HR — waiting rooms are non-negotiable."

Host Controls — Say:

"Once everyone is in, lock the meeting. There's a 'Security' button in your toolbar — click it and choose 'Lock Meeting.' No one else can join after that point, even with the link and password. Do this for confidential calls."

Participant Permissions — Say:

"You control what participants can do. Under the Security button and Participants panel, you can restrict who can share their screen, who can chat, whether participants can rename themselves, and whether annotations are allowed. For presentations or formal meetings, tighten these up."

Recording Consent — Say:

"If you're recording, say so out loud at the start — even though Zoom sends a pop-up notification. It's good professional practice, and in some states, it's legally required. Also, check your organization's recording policy before you hit record."

Account Settings — Say:

"Finally, your own account. Enable two-factor authentication. Use a professional photo. Set your notification preferences so you're not disrupted during focused work. These take five minutes and make a difference."

Common Mistakes — Say:

"Let me quickly run through the mistakes I see most often. Don't share meeting links on social media or in public channels — that's an invitation for uninvited guests. Don't use your Personal Meeting ID for public events, because your PMI never changes — anyone who has it can try to join your calls in the future."

"Don't leave screen share running when you switch apps — always stop sharing before you switch. And when you're done with a meeting, don't just close the window — click 'End Meeting for All.' If you just close the window, the meeting may keep running."

"And when admitting from the waiting room, check the name before you click admit. If you don't recognize someone, don't let them in."

CHAT MONITOR	This is a good slide to watch for questions. Participants often have specific security scenarios they want to ask about — flag any good questions for the group discussion.

BREAK 2

Slide —	10-Minute Break	2:15 – 2:25

Say:

"Great work, everyone. Let's take our second break — ten minutes. When we come back, it's all practice. You'll get a chance to host your own meeting from scratch, try the security settings, and work in a breakout room. Then we'll close with Q&A."

CHAT MONITOR Post break end time in chat. Compile all unanswered chat questions from the session so far and have them ready for Q&A.

MODULE 7: Practice Session & Q&A

Slide 10	Practice Scenarios + Q&A Roles	2:25 – 3:00

Intro — Say:

"Welcome back — final stretch. This is the part where you actually do everything we've talked about. I'll walk you through three scenarios. Don't worry if it's not perfect — that's why we practice now, not on a real client call."

Scenario A: Host a Meeting from Scratch — Say:

"Scenario A. I want you to host a meeting. Here's what you're going to do: schedule a meeting, start it, admit a participant from the waiting room — use your neighbor or a colleague — share your screen, then end the meeting properly."

"Take about eight minutes. [Chat monitor name] will be in chat if you need help. Go ahead."

ACTION	Monitor participants. Watch for confusion. The secondary instructor handles chat support. After 8 minutes, call everyone back and debrief briefly: "What was easy? What was tricky?"

Scenario B: Breakout Room — Say:

"For scenario B, I'm going to split us into breakout rooms of three or four. Your task in the room: introduce yourselves, pick one Zoom feature you learned today that you think your colleagues don't know about, and be ready to share it with the full group."

"You'll have seven minutes. I'll visit each room to check in."

ACTION	Open breakout rooms. Assign groups automatically. Set a 7-minute timer. Visit each room briefly. Close rooms at the 7-minute mark.

CHAT MONITOR	Post the task in chat before rooms open: "Breakout Room Task: Introduce yourselves, then choose one Zoom feature to share with the group when you return."

After the rooms close, ask one person from each group to share their feature:

"Welcome back. Let's hear from each group — what feature did you pick?"

Scenario C: Secure a Call — Say:

"Last scenario. I want you to practice the security steps. Enable your waiting room, start a meeting, lock it after everyone is in, and walk through the participant permissions. If you want, try removing a participant — [name] has volunteered to be a test participant, you can remove and re-admit."

"Take about five minutes."

Q&A — Say:

"We have about fifteen minutes for questions. [Chat monitor name], what questions came in during the session that we haven't addressed yet?"

CHAT MONITOR	Read out the compiled list of unanswered questions. Respond to any remaining chat questions. Prioritize questions that apply to the whole group.

"I also want to open it up directly — what questions does anyone have? Don't be shy — there are no basic questions here."

Allow time for verbal questions. If energy is low, seed with:

"Here's something I often get asked: What do you do when your audio suddenly stops working mid-meeting? Anyone want to take a guess?"

Closing

Slide 11 | **You're Ready to Zoom!** | 2:55 – 3:00

Say:

"And that's a wrap. You've covered a lot of ground today — from installing Zoom all the way through security, collaboration, and live practice. Give yourselves a hand."

"Let me leave you with the three habits that matter most. Always enable your waiting room for sensitive meetings. Use a virtual background to stay professional wherever you're working. And mute yourself when you're not speaking — every single time."

"You're each getting a quick-reference card and a keyboard shortcuts list in your email. [Chat monitor name] is posting the links to Zoom's help center in chat right now."

CHAT MONITOR Post: "Zoom Help Center: https://support.zoom.us | Keyboard Shortcuts: https://support.zoom.us/hc/en-us/articles/205683899 | Thanks for joining today!"

"If you have questions after today, reach out to [contact info / IT helpdesk / etc.]. [Name] and I will be available for another ten minutes if anyone wants to stay on."

"Thanks, everyone — have a great rest of your day!"

ACTION End the meeting for all using the red 'End' button. Do NOT just close the window.

Appendix: Quick Reference for Instructors

Common Technical Issues & Responses

Issue	Suggested Response
The participant can't hear the audio	Ask them to leave and rejoin. Check that Zoom has microphone permission in their system settings.
Participant's video is black	Ask them to stop and restart their video. Check camera permissions.
Screen share is laggy/blurry	Ask them to close bandwidth-heavy apps (streaming, downloads). Reduce video quality in Settings > Video.
Participant accidentally left the meeting	Have them use the original link to rejoin. Admit from the waiting room.
Echo or feedback on audio	Usually caused by two devices in the same room. Ask participants to use headphones or mute one device.
Chat monitor can't see questions	Remind them to check the 'Everyone' dropdown in the Chat panel — not just direct messages.

Key Transitions Between Sections

- **"Now that we know how to get in, let's look at what we can do once we're there."** Module 1 → 2:
- **"Great work. Take ten minutes, grab a drink, and we'll pick up with collaboration tools."** Module 2 → Break:
- **"Welcome back — we're moving into my favorite part: collaboration."** Break → Module 4:
- **"Before we get to practice, let's spend a few minutes on something that can save you from some real professional headaches: security."** Module 4 → 5:
- **"That's security covered. Take another ten, and when we're back it's all practice and Q&A."** Module 5 → Break:
- **"You've all done great work today. Let's bring it home."** Practice → Closing:

Timing Guide

Section	Content	Time
Pre-session	Setup, welcome participants	–0:00 to 0:00
Slides 1–3	Intro, agenda	0:00 – 0:12
Module 1	Getting started (Slides 4–5)	0:12 – 0:42
Module 2	Controls (Slides 6–7)	0:42 – 1:00
Break 1	—	1:00 – 1:10
Module 4	Collaboration (Slide 8)	1:10 – 1:45
Module 5	Security (Slide 9)	1:45 – 2:15

Section	Content	Time
Break 2	—	2:15 – 2:25
Module 7	Practice & Q&A (Slide 10)	2:25 – 2:55
Closing	Slide 11	2:55 – 3:00